OpenClaw Model Switching

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1. Course Content

This course will systematically introduce OpenClaw's model selection mechanism and three methods for switching models.

2. Temporary Session Model Switching

2.1 Open TUI Session

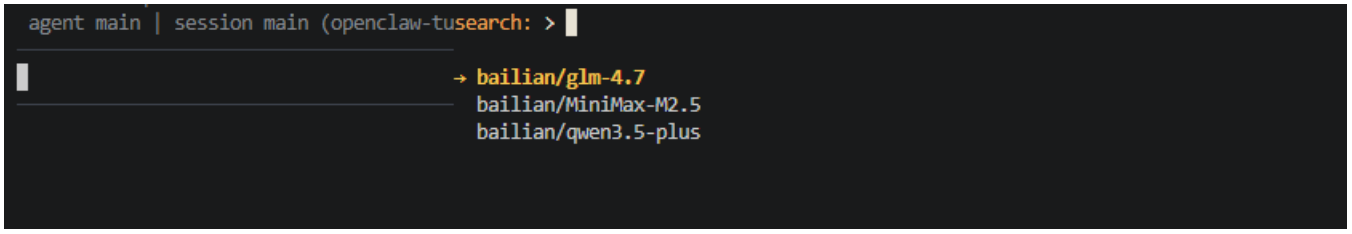
- Terminal input

```
openclaw tui
```

2.2 Use /model to Switch Session Model

Command	Description
`/model`	View available model list, select and switch model

- Type `/model` in the session box and press Enter. For example, here we select to switch to `bailian/qwen3.5-plus`. Use keyboard up/down keys to select model, then press Enter



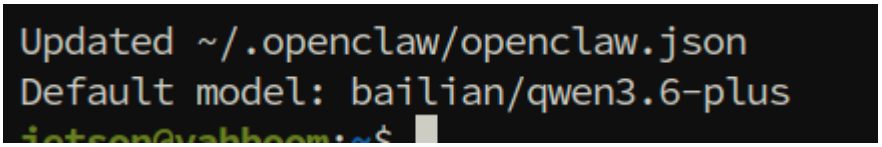
3. Switch Default Model

3.1 Switch via CLI

The simplest way is to use CLI command to directly set the default model:

- Here we use switching to `bailian/qwen3.6-plus` model as an example

```
openclaw models set bailian/qwen3.6-plus
```



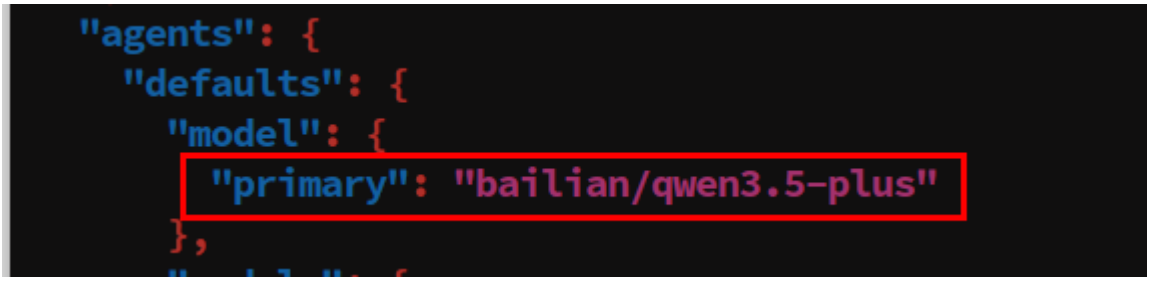
3.2 Switch via Configuration File

- Edit `openclaw.json` configuration file to modify Agent's default model

  ```
  nano $HOME/.openclaw/openclaw.json
  # Or use your preferred editor, such as vim, code, etc.
  ```

In `openclaw.json`, specify the default primary model through the `agents.defaults.model.primary` configuration item:

```
{
  "agents": {
    "defaults": {
      "model": {
        "primary": "bailian/qwen3.5-plus"
      }
    }
  }
}
```



- Verify if configuration takes effect:

```
openclaw models status
```

```
Config         : ~/.openclaw/openclaw.json
Agent dir      : ~/.openclaw/agents/main/agent
Default        : bailian/qwen3.5-plus
Fallbacks (0) : -
Image model    : -
Image fallbacks (0): -
Aliases (0)    : -
Configured models (9): bailian/qwen3.5-plus, bailian/qwen3.6-plus, bailian/qwen3-max-2026-01-23, bailian/qwen3-coder-next, bailian/qwen3-coder-plus, bailian/MiniMax-M2.5, bailian/glm-5, bailian/glm-4.7, bailian/kimi-k2.5
```

4. Add Model Options List

- `agents.defaults.models` is OpenClaw's **allowed list/catalog** that controls the range of usable models. When this configuration item is set, users can only use models contained in the list. This list serves as the model range control basis for both the `/model` command and session overrides.

4.1 Add Models via Configuration File

Configure `agents.defaults.models` in `openclaw.json` and add required models to the allowed list. Insert the following block **inside the root object** of the existing `openclaw.json` (it is a fragment, not a complete file):

```
"agents": {
    "defaults": {
      "model": {
        "primary": "bailian/qwen3.5-plus"
      },
      "models": {
        "bailian/qwen3.5-plus": {},
        "bailian/MiniMax-M2.5": {},
        "bailian/glm-4.7": {}
      },
      "workspace": "/home/jetson/.openclaw/workspace",
      "compaction": {
        "mode": "safeguard",
        "memoryFlush": {
          "enabled": false
        }
      }
    }
  }
```



4.2 Model Reference Format Specification

In OpenClaw, all model references use a unified format:

```
provider/model-id
```

Examples:

Model Reference	Description
`anthropic/claude-opus-4-6`	Anthropic's Claude Opus model
`anthropic/claude-sonnet-4-6`	Anthropic's Claude Sonnet model
`openai/gpt-5.4`	OpenAI's GPT-5.4 model
`openrouter/moonshotai/kimi-k2`	Model ID itself contains slash

> **Note**: If the model ID itself contains `/` (e.g., `moonshotai/kimi-k2`), you must provide the complete reference in the format `openrouter/moonshotai/kimi-k2`.

5. Appendix: CLI Command Quick Reference

Command	Purpose
`openclaw onboard`	New user guidance, helps quickly complete initial configuration
`openclaw models list`	View all configured model list
`openclaw models status`	View current model configuration status details
`/model`	View available model list in chat
`/model status`	View current model status details in chat